

ANTON OSIKA — SVG GUEST DOSSIER

Prepared 8 September 2026. Built from 5 full timestamped interview transcripts (Sep 2025 – Apr 2026), 44 X posts and 32 LinkedIn posts from the last 90 days, funding filings and press.

RESEARCH

WHO HE IS

Anton Osika is co-founder and CEO of Lovable, a Stockholm platform where you describe an app in plain English and the AI builds it, hosts it, and connects payments, email and a database. No code is written by the user. It sells on subscription: free plan, \$25 Pro, \$50 Business, and enterprise contracts, and it makes money on the building, not the hosting, which is free ([Osika on X, 31 Aug 2026](#); [TWiST 28:20](#)). He runs the company with co-founder and CTO Fabian Hedin. He is 36 (born 10 August 1990) and became a billionaire in December 2025 when the company hit a \$6.6B valuation ([Wikipedia](#)). The current hook: on 12 August 2026 Lovable raised **\$400M at a \$13.3B valuation**, doubling its price in eight months ([TechCrunch, 12 Aug 2026](#)).

PATH

He studied physics — BSc at Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, MSc in Engineering Physics at KTH in Stockholm — and worked on the ATLAS experiment at CERN. He left, and his reason is worth hearing: "they're all working on these impossible problems without any elasticity" ([Sequoia 5:31](#), VERBATIM). He was an early engineer at Sana Labs, then co-founder and CTO of Depict.ai, a Y Combinator e-commerce recommendations company that raised \$20M and then lost momentum ([Sequoia 6:46](#); [Wikipedia](#)).

The founding insight came from being the person everyone asked for a favour. "All my life I've been approached by people who wanted to find a great engineer to help them realize their dreams or the ideas... 0.5% of the world can even code" ([Sequoia 7:21](#), VERBATIM). His decision was to aim at the other side: "let's build something for the 99% and not this productivity boost for developers" ([Sequoia 7:36](#), VERBATIM). In 2023 he released GPT Engineer as open source, woke up one morning convinced, biked to Fabian Hedin's place and called him for a walk ([GAEA 3:36](#)). They launched the commercial product as Lovable in **November/December 2024 with eight people** ([Shira Lazar 9:44](#)).

THE COMPANY RIGHT NOW (last 6 months)

The August 2026 round: \$400M at \$13.3B, led by Menlo Ventures with the Scaleup Europe Fund (managed by EQT) co-leading. In the eight months since the December Series B, projects built on Lovable went from 25M to 60M, monthly visits to Lovable-built apps went from 200M to 900M, and ARR nearly tripled. Annualised run rate passed **\$500M in June 2026**. Sources: [Osika on LinkedIn, 12 Aug 2026](#) · [TechCrunch](#) · [Wikipedia funding history](#).

The ARR ladder, in his own telling: \$100M fastest ever, \$200M at the one-year anniversary, \$300M two months later in February 2026 ([Shira Lazar 2:03](#)), then \$500M by June. Headcount went from **10 to 250+ in 18 months** ([X, 19 Jun 2026](#)), and he insists on in-person work. On 1 September 2026 he said more than **1B prompts** have been sent to Lovable, and that the platform now picks the model for you: "The model picker era is coming to an end... we don't want you to think about models" ([X, 1 Sep 2026](#), VERBATIM). On 23 July 2026 Lovable was certified under AIUC-1, a third-party AI security standard, audited by Schellman ([LinkedIn](#)).

Two numbers that reframe who actually uses this. **55% of Lovable users have 11 or more years of professional experience** ([LinkedIn, 7 Sep 2026](#)), and **30% of Fortune 1000 companies** were on it as of October 2025 ([Masters of Scale 8:07](#)). Brazil is the second-largest user base after the US ([X, 26 Jun 2026](#)).

8 FACTS WORTH KNOWING

- 1. A man on a Swedish island makes \$300,000 a month selling Renaissance-style oil portraits of people's dogs.** Damian wanted a framed painting of his own dog, built the product on Lovable, connected it to a print-and-ship service, and launched it as a business. Osika's reaction: "I couldn't believe it at first" ([Shira Lazar 26:07](#), VERBATIM).
- 2. The fastest revenue story he tells is 48 hours.** Kaio, founder of the Brazilian education company Q Group, sat down and built a premium product line himself in about three weeks, launched it into his existing distribution, and made **\$3M in the first two days** ([TWiST 34:47](#); [Masters of Scale 6:15](#)).

3. **A student team hit €130K ARR in 30 days.** Klar, built by students who thought formal education was too rigid, built the product on Lovable. Osika invested in them ([X, 8 Jul 2026](#)).
4. **A corporate intranet that a quote priced at \$500,000 took four hours and cost under \$2,000.** Built by one of Jason Calacanis's employees ([X, 17 Jul 2026](#)). Separately, a real-estate company with 80,000 agents was quoted a year for a full replatform of its websites; the VP of marketing rebuilt it on Lovable and saved \$2M ([Shira Lazar 17:06](#)).
5. **His concrete instruction to anyone worried about their job is one day long.** "Sit down for one full day or like a few days even better with a new AI tool. And if you just do that you're going to be better than almost everyone else and probably everyone in your company at using this new tool" ([Masters of Scale 15:20](#), VERBATIM).
6. **Designers are the fastest-growing group of builders on the platform,** and he thinks that fixes the AI-slop problem rather than causing it: "More designers building software means better designed software" ([X, 19 Jun 2026](#), VERBATIM).
7. **At Sweden's top technical university, the share of students who plan to start a company went from 8% to 80% in ten years** ([TWiST 41:36](#)). Founders and small-company entrepreneurs, not students, are Lovable's biggest revenue source today ([TWiST 42:15](#)).
8. **He said "\$25 million" instead of "\$25" for a Lovable subscription on live television, then posted the correction himself.** "My team politely asked me to clarify... I apologize for the confusion." Follow-up post: "in my defense it was early morning." It is his most-liked post of the last 90 days at 3,678 likes ([X, 31 Aug 2026](#), VERBATIM).

HIS THESIS / WHAT HE SAYS PUBLICLY

The 99% argument is the whole company. Fewer than 1% of people could ever build software, and he thinks that's where most good ideas were stranded: "99% of the good ideas are in the 99% who were not able to before" ([Masters of Scale 5:53](#), VERBATIM). He frames Lovable as a technical co-founder you rent for \$25 a month.

On jobs, he refuses the framing rather than softening it. "There's this 'oh AI is going to take jobs' mindset for some people. I think it's the wrong perspective of a fixed pie mindset. And we're now baking entirely new pies that you can take a slice of" ([Shira Lazar 25:36](#), VERBATIM). Asked directly whether vibe coding is cheating, he compared it to the calculator: once considered cheating, now just a tool "to increase your competitiveness in the job market" ([TWiST 49:53](#), VERBATIM).

He has a dated prediction on the record. In October 2025 he said that within five years, all new software will be built by explaining it in plain English, and "there will be handwritten code in the same sense that there's like handmade clothes" ([Masters of Scale 17:02](#), VERBATIM). In September 2025 he predicted that within 18 months — so by roughly March 2027 — a Lovable-built app would be twice as secure on average as one built from scratch by a competent human ([TWiST 23:52](#)).

Where he says the advantage now sits. "Creativity is becoming the only moat in building great products" ([X, 7 Sep 2026](#), VERBATIM), and separately, "Community is one of the remaining moats in technology that can't be replicated" ([X, 31 Jul 2026](#), VERBATIM). His stated bottleneck for a good product is not technical: "the biggest bottlenecks for building good software products is some kind of product judgment and just empathy for what your customers want" ([Masters of Scale 14:29](#), VERBATIM).

He names who loses. "Some SaaS companies that are relying on hefty margins today are going to naturally see a decline in the revenue" as single-person startups with better product taste undercut them ([Masters of Scale 10:31](#), VERBATIM). He wants Lovable to be where the first one-person unicorn gets built ([Masters of Scale 7:24](#)), and he says publicly the plan is the first trillion-dollar company out of Europe ([TWiST 18:09](#)).

STALE VS FRESH

STALE — he has a rehearsed answer, expect the same words:

- The bike ride to Fabian's place and the 6AM walk. Told nearly identically at [GAEA 3:36](#) and [Shira Lazar 7:47](#). Compress to one line.
- "The 99%" / "0.5% of the world can code." He opens with it everywhere: [Sequoia 7:21](#), [Masters of Scale 5:40](#), [TWiST 18:49](#), [Shira Lazar 27:52](#).
- The Q Group \$3M-in-48-hours story. Told at least three times: [TWiST 34:47](#), [Masters of Scale 6:15](#), [Shira Lazar 35:01](#).

- "Are we in a bubble?" and "will AI take jobs?" Answered on camera repeatedly with the fixed-pie line ([Shira Lazar 25:36, 29:26](#)).
- Why Europe / why Stockholm. A full set piece at [Sequoia 35:58](#) and again in his 21 June 2026 posts.

FRESH — nobody has pushed on these:

- **He has quietly abandoned the term that made him famous.** On 23 July 2026: "You won't hear me say 'vibe coding' much anymore... We're way past vibes now" ([LinkedIn](#), VERBATIM). Eight months earlier he was happily explaining vibe coding on a Masters of Scale stage. No interviewer has asked him what changed, or what he calls it now.
- **The security prediction has a deadline and a counter-example.** He said 18 months to 2x-better-than-human security in September 2025. Seven months later, in April 2026, Lovable was publicly disclosed to have left every pre-November-2025 project's source code and database credentials readable by any free account for 48 days. Nobody has put the prediction and the incident in the same question.
- **"55% of our users have 11+ years of experience" contradicts the pitch.** The public story is the 99% and the 16-year-old building a social app. The data he posted on 7 September 2026 says the core user is a mid-career professional. That is exactly the SVG viewer, and no one has asked him to describe that person.
- **What he'd build now, if he weren't running Lovable.** He sees 200,000 new projects a day and personally invests in some ([Klar](#)). He has never been asked which categories are working and which are saturated.
- **The 996 admission.** On the Sequoia podcast he said many people at Lovable work 996-plus, that expectations are set before you join, and that they have lost senior candidates who could only do 50 hours a week — "but that's maybe good" ([Sequoia 43:17](#), VERBATIM). He also says he sleeps between four and seven and a half hours and that sleep raises his work quality ([Shira Lazar 21:17](#)). Both are on record; neither has been put to him against the other.
- **He says he "started ~250 repos" before Lovable** ([X, 26 Aug 2026](#)). A 250-failures-then-one-hit framing that nobody has drawn out.

QUICK EXPLAINER — WHAT "VIBE CODING" ACTUALLY MEANS

The term was coined by AI researcher Andrej Karpathy, not by Osika, and Osika says so plainly ([Shira Lazar 16:31](#)). It means you never look at the code: you describe what you want in plain language, look at the working app, and keep talking to the AI until it's right. Osika's framing on air: humans used to read the ones and zeros the computer reads, then stopped; this is the next step in that same shift ([Masters of Scale 3:19](#)). Lovable's specific bet is an opinionated stack — one fixed set of technical choices under the hood — which he argues makes it more reliable for non-engineers than open-ended tools ([TWiST 26:10](#)).

WHY IT'S HAPPENING NOW

Three things converged. The models got good enough to hold a whole product in context and act on it, and the big labs ship a materially better one roughly every three months ([TWiST 25:59](#)). The plumbing got absorbed: payments, database, email, custom domain and hosting are now one-click inside the platform, so the non-technical builder never touches infrastructure ([Shira Lazar 15:10](#)). And the audience turned out not to be hobbyists — corporate product managers, designers, finance and ops teams found it first, because building the thing is faster than writing the document asking for it. Meta's internal mantra, as Osika reports it: "demo, don't memo" ([Masters of Scale 9:07](#), VERBATIM).

THE NUMBERS

Lovable: \$500M+ ARR, \$13.3B valuation, 60M projects built, 900M monthly visits to apps made on it, 250+ employees, 1B+ prompts processed, 106,000+ members in its Discord and 1,340 community events run worldwide. For scale, he says roughly 200,000 new projects are created every day ([GAEA 3:59](#)) against about 50 million professional developers on earth ([TWiST 33:25](#)). The company went from launch to \$500M ARR in about 19 months. Sources: [TechCrunch](#) · [X, 12 Aug 2026](#) · [X, 31 Jul 2026](#) · [TWiST 42:54](#).

WHAT TO PULL UP LIVE

- Build something on camera from a prompt Marina writes live: [lovable.dev](#). A working app in under ten minutes is the whole episode in one shot, and it's what Shira Lazar did ([17:56](#)).

- The pricing page, because the \$25-vs-\$25-million clip is a natural laugh and a natural way into "what does this actually cost me": lovable.dev/pricing.
- His own profile of things people built: lovable.dev/@antonosika.

DEFENDED POSITIONS & PUSHBACK FILE

1. "In 18 months, AI-built software will be 2x more secure than what a good human builds." Said September 2025 ([TWiST 23:52](#)). **Counter:** studies put the share of AI-generated code containing security vulnerabilities at roughly 40–62%, and the Cloud Security Alliance counted at least 20 documented incidents across AI-built apps in a single research pass, nearly all tracing to missing authorization and secrets exposed in client code ([Superblocks analysis](#)). CVE-2025-48757, affecting 170+ Lovable-built apps, exposed home addresses, API keys and personal debt figures because generated projects shipped without row-level security ([VibeAppScanner](#)). **His documented defence:** he does not claim parity today — "I cannot say that it's more secure than a security expert today... I do recommend looping in a security expert for life and death applications" ([TWiST 22:43](#), VERBATIM) — and he argues the direction is inevitable, comparing it to the 1960s decision to let a computer, not a pilot, fly the rocket ([TWiST 21:55](#)). The AIUC-1 certification in July 2026 and "secured code by default" as a stated priority in the funding announcement are the concrete response.

2. "You can build a real business on this, not just a prototype." **Counter:** independent comparisons of the 2026 tools put Lovable at roughly 7/10 on production quality, behind v0 and Windsurf, and a common recommendation is to prototype on Lovable and then hire a developer to ship ([tool comparison round-up](#)). Replit raised \$400M at \$9B in the same window, so the category is well funded and contested ([Tech Insider](#)). **His documented defence:** he points at 900M monthly visits to apps built on the platform as proof it is production traffic, not toys — "that's not like 'oh someone vibe coded something cool.' This is real production software" ([Shira Lazar 29:31](#), VERBATIM) — and concedes the boundary himself: Facebook-scale is out of reach, the target is 95% of SaaS ([TWiST 48:43](#)).

3. "Working in person, at very high intensity, is how you build this." He requires in-office work ([X, 19 Jun 2026](#)) and says many at Lovable work 996-plus. **Counter:** he acknowledges losing senior candidates over it and answers "but that's maybe good" ([Sequoia 43:17](#)). The tension is that a company whose entire pitch is that one person can now do what a team did is itself running on 250 people at maximum intensity. **His documented defence:** he frames it as explicit expectation-setting rather than imposition, says people with families are accommodated if impact is clear, and separately argues that hiring humans still beats agents because "ultra-reliable long-horizon is very valuable" ([LinkedIn, 28 Jun 2026](#), VERBATIM).

The one incident with context: on 3 March 2026 a security researcher reported through Lovable's bug bounty that a flaw in its API let anyone with a free account read other users' project source code, database credentials and AI chat history. Lovable patched it for newly created projects but left every project created before November 2025 exposed. The researcher disclosed publicly on 20 April 2026, 48 days later. Exposed material included records from a Danish nonprofit and personal details tied to employees at several large tech companies. Lovable initially called the exposed data intentional behaviour and pointed at unclear documentation and its bug bounty partner, then issued a partial apology acknowledging that "pointing to documentation issues alone was not enough" ([TNW](#); [Vibe Graveyard timeline](#)). No public statement from Osika himself has been found on this specific incident. His general position, stated repeatedly since, is that security is the platform's job, not the user's: "you can build and run your business... without needing to become a security expert" ([X, 12 Aug 2026](#), VERBATIM).

RECENT INTERVIEWS — FOR THE PRODUCER

- 1. 40 Million Products Built Without Code** — GAEA Talks (HumanX), 30 Apr 2026, 623,602 views, 13 min — <https://youtu.be/xveOgrL5UC4> — *by far the widest reach; tight and quotable.*
- 2. Meta's "creepy" new Ray Bans and a visit from Lovable CEO Anton Osika (E2181)** — This Week in Startups, 19 Sep 2025, 357,219 views, 74 min — <https://youtu.be/ST4UwQodhDs> — *his segment starts at 17:00; the security and unit-economics answers live here.*
- 3. Scaling AI Rocketships: ElevenLabs' Mati Staniszewski & Lovable's Anton Osika** — Sequoia Capital, 11 Dec 2025, 77,266 views, 57 min — <https://youtu.be/TqAgejIX7uU> — *the operator interview: hiring, delegation, 996, Europe.*
- 4. He Built Lovable, the \$6B AI Company Letting Anyone Create Software** — Shira Lazar, 18 Feb 2026, 39,527 views, 49 min — <https://youtu.be/jr9ESVotyMo> — *closest format to SVG; the \$300K/month dog-portrait story is here.*

5. **On turning ideas into software without coding** — Pioneers of AI / Masters of Scale Summit, 17 Oct 2025, 13,460 views, 20 min — <https://youtu.be/9FGMhz-e97k> — *the clearest statement of the five-year prediction.*

No prior SVG appearance. Recent tier-1 audio: **Sequoia's Crucible Moments/Long Strange Trip** with Harry Stebbings-style operator questions, and **All-In** at Versailles in July 2026 ([his post](#)). **SVG's differentiation:** every existing interview interviews him as a founder — how he scaled, how he hires, why Europe. Not one asks him the viewer's question: I have a job, a domain I know well, and no company. What exactly do I build, and what does the first month look like? He has the data to answer it and has never been asked.

IMPORTANT POSTS — X AND LINKEDIN

X / Twitter — [@antonosika](#) (83.6K followers; bio reads "eu/acc"). He writes these himself, drafting in Typefully after a 15-minute Monday idea session with his team ([Sequoia 28:15](#)).

- **12 Aug 2026 — the \$400M / \$13.3B announcement.** The full thesis in one post, including the 900M-visits number and the pledge on security by default. [Link](#)
- **7 Sep 2026 — "Creativity is becoming the only moat in building great products."** Nine words, his most recent thesis statement, and the natural spine for the episode. [Link](#)
- **1 Sep 2026 — "The model picker era is coming to an end."** 1B+ prompts, and the argument that orchestrating models beats owning one. [Link](#)
- **21 Jul 2026 — "The road to entrepreneurship is filled with bad advice. Don't listen to anyone who tells you to try less."** His most direct line to an ambitious viewer. [Link](#)
- **18 Aug 2026 — the sauna boat.** He spent it asking the boat's owner what his biggest problems were. Talking to customers, made concrete. [Link](#)
- **1 Sep 2026 — "university is the place you meet your future cofounder / just try not to drop out.."** Contrarian against the drop-out myth, and rare. [Link](#)
- **23 Jul 2026 · REPOST — "Everything runs on trust."** Amplifying his own security team's hiring post. Worth flagging as the position he chooses to boost. [Link](#)

LinkedIn — [antonosika](#) (heavier on company news; several posts are cross-posts of the X versions).

- **23 Jul 2026 — "You won't hear me say 'vibe coding' much anymore... We're way past vibes now."** The single most interesting post in either feed: the founder most associated with the term walking away from it, on the day of the AIUC-1 certification. [Link](#)
- **7 Sep 2026 — "55% of people using Lovable have 11+ years of professional experience."** Reframes the whole audience. [Link](#)
- **8 Sep 2026 — university buildathons.** Posted today. "One person can now build things that would have taken an entire team not long ago." [Link](#)
- **1 Sep 2026 · REPOST — what to study now.** "Go to university to meet people you like, prioritize projects that give you real world experience over coursework... and you should start building things." [Link](#)
- **6 Jul 2026 — the Dala horse ordering system,** built end to end in days by a non-engineer on the People team. The cleanest "an ordinary employee built real internal software" example. [Link](#)

Instagram and other platforms: not auto-collected and not checked manually for this pass. If wanted, send a screenshot or caption and it can be folded in.

SHOW-NOTES SOURCES

- <https://youtu.be/xveOgrL5UC4> · <https://youtu.be/ST4UwQodhDs> · <https://youtu.be/TqAgejIX7uU> · <https://youtu.be/jr9ESVOTyMo> · <https://youtu.be/9FGMhz-e97k>
- <https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/12/lovable-confirms-new-13-3b-valuation-raises-another-400m/> · [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lovable_\(company\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lovable_(company)) · https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Anton_Osika
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